

Cashew potato leek soup

This soup has made an impressive transformation from a vichyssoise, made with dairy cream, to an even richer, **creamier** soup, made with cashew cream. Its pale green color contrasts subtly with the cashew cream.

If you're ambitious and want to really dress up the soup, make some crispy fried leeks or shallots and **sprinkle** them on top when serving (see page 6). The effect is very much worth the effort.

3 to 4 leeks (white and light green parts),
coarsely chopped and well rinsed (see *Note*)

2 tablespoons olive oil

3 medium baking potatoes, peeled and cut
into large chunks

6 cups Basic Vegetable Stock (page 45) [1.5L]

1 teaspoon salt

$\frac{1}{4}$ teaspoon freshly ground pepper

1 cup unsalted raw cashews [120g]

About 1 cup apple juice [250ml]

Chopped fresh chives, for garnish

1. **Soften** the leeks in the olive oil over medium-low heat in a covered soup pot without allowing them to brown, about 5 minutes. Stir occasionally. Add the potatoes, stock, salt, and pepper. Bring to a boil. Reduce the heat and cook for 30 minutes, or until the potatoes are very soft.
2. While the soup is cooking, **prepare** the cashew cream by pureeing the cashews and apple juice in a blender until very creamy. Add more juice or water if the cream is too thick. Set aside in a small bowl or measuring cup and rinse out the blender.
3. In small batches, **ladle** roughly equal amounts of potatoes, leeks, and stock into a blender or a food processor. Puree until very smooth. Serve warm or reheat.
4. **Decorate** the soup with the cashew cream or blend it in entirely. (It's completely up to you how you want to proceed with this part of the soup. Visually, the

off-white of the cream marked against the light green of the soup makes an excellent presentation. However, if you mix in the cream thoroughly, you will still have a deeply satisfying soup.) Season again with salt and pepper, if desired. Top with chopped chives or crispy leeks, if using.

SERVES 6 TO 8

note To clean leeks, which are usually layered with dirt, slice them in half lengthwise and then into half-moons. Soak in a large bowl or sink filled with cold water. Swish the leeks around with your hands, allowing any grit to settle to the bottom. Lift out the leeks and repeat, if necessary.

